

IG

Instagram SNS Manual

JICA Kyrgyzstan Instagram Operations Guide — Print
Edition

This is an internal manual for staff use.

Internal reference / same content as the web version

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01 Purpose, Target Audience & Content Strategy	Understand why we post, who we're reaching, and what we should be saying.
02 Method	Learn how to plan, shoot, edit, and post an actual Instagram post.
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05 How to Write Website Articles	Learn how to write articles for the JICA Kyrgyz Republic Office's official website, and how to take photos for them.

Purpose, Target Audience & Content Strategy

Understand why we post, who we're reaching, and what we should be saying.

What you'll learn in this section

Explain why JICA runs an Instagram account and what its goals are

Explain who the account is speaking to (main target audiences)

Understand the 3 content categories and how to structure each one

1. The purpose of running Instagram

1-1. Why we run Instagram

Instagram isn't only used to "look things up" — people use it every day as entertainment.

That's why it's important not to simply explain JICA's activities one-sidedly, but to create **content people find "useful," "interesting," and want to know more about.**

On Instagram, it's not just individual posts that get noticed — **the account itself is recognized as a brand.** That's why we keep content, design, writing, the profile, and Highlights consistent, so it's instantly recognizable as "the JICA account."

2. Account strategy

2-1. What account strategy means

Instagram account strategy means clarifying these three points.



Who

Who are we reaching?



What

What are we telling them?



Goal

What do we want to achieve?

In other words, account strategy isn't simply "posting information about JICA" — it's **deciding what to say and how, based on the target audience.**

3. Goals of running Instagram

3-1. Ultimate goal

Through Instagram, raise awareness, understanding, and familiarity with JICA.

We also aim to build a positive image of the role JICA plays and the activities it carries out in Kyrgyzstan.

3-2. Medium-term goal

In Kyrgyzstan, even ministry and government officials use Instagram to gather information. With that in mind, the medium-term goal is best split into reach beyond current followers and depth with existing followers.

Reach beyond followers

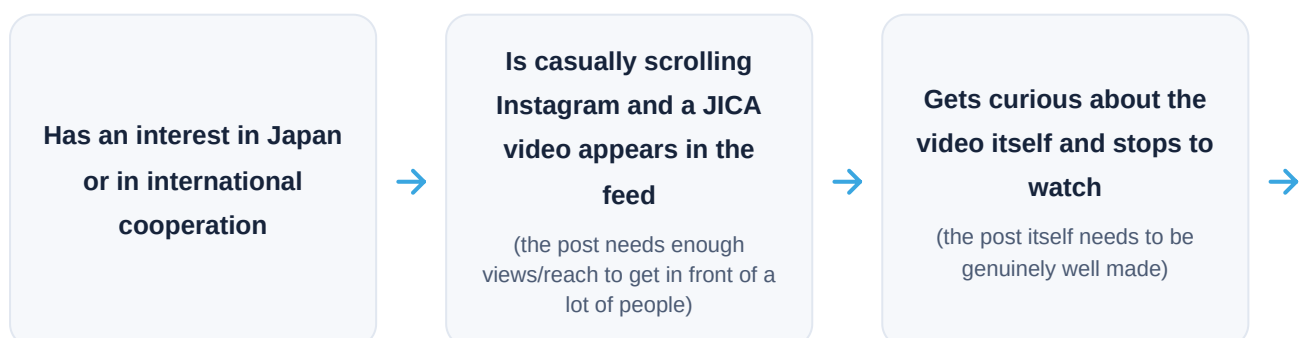
The goal is for people to **stumble across a JICA post while casually browsing Instagram on a break — and follow the account** as a result.

Depth with followers

The goal is for existing followers to **come away genuinely understanding what JICA does and how it contributes.**

4. Target audience

The journey we're aiming for



Becomes interested in JICA and follows the account

(the video needs to actually introduce JICA's work)

4-1. Main target audiences

A

Government officials & ministry staff in their 20s–30s

People who may be directly or indirectly connected to JICA's projects. When they come across a JICA post while browsing Instagram personally, we want to create this progression:

"Oh, so this is what JICA does"



"This is interesting"



"I want to know more"



Follow

B

People aged 10–30 interested in Japanese culture and language

Japanese-language learners, Japanese-culture communities, young people interested in Japan, etc. For this group, it's effective to use Japanese and Kyrgyz culture and people as an entry point into JICA, rather than only explaining JICA directly.

5. Basic content policy

What matters when introducing JICA on Instagram isn't "explaining JICA" — it's "creating a reason to want to know more about JICA."

When creating a post, always ask: **"Why would someone seeing this post for the first time watch it to the end?"** In Reels especially, give a "reason to watch" within the first few seconds.

NG

"Today we're introducing the project."

Why? This is purely explanatory and gives no "reason to watch" in the first few seconds, so viewers tend to drop off.

GOOD

"Why does this road stay usable even in winter?"

Why? Opening with a question makes viewers curious about what comes next, so they keep watching.

 The source material also recommends avoiding long greetings/introductions and presenting the key message or question right away.

6. Content categories

Core content is divided into the following 3 categories.

①

News & Updates

Share JICA's latest news.

- Important meetings
- VIP visits
- Events

However, don't make this a plain "activity report."

Basic structure

Why → What → Who → So What?

Why: why was this activity needed?



What: what did JICA do?



Who: who was involved?



So What: what changed as a result / why does it matter?

 NG

Just "The ○○ project was awarded"

 GOOD

Turn it into a story: "Kyrgyzstan had this ○○ challenge → JICA carried out ○○ → worked together with ○○ ministry/local communities → this led to ○○ → and this effort has now been recognized."

Concrete example (an important meeting)

Why

Wanting to stabilize the dairy industry

What

Training people to raise product quality

Who

A regional governor and staff from partner companies

So What?

The groundwork for training is now in place, and quality has improved significantly

②

Our Activities: Introducing JICA's work

Don't just list the project name, partners, purpose, and duration when introducing a project.

Basic structure

Why → What → Result → Today

Why: what challenge
existed in Kyrgyzstan?



What: what did JICA do?



Result: what changed?



Today: how does it connect to the present?

This turns a project "description" into **a story about what actually changed because of JICA's work.**

Concrete example (OVOP)

Why

Rural communities were declining, and women held low social status

What

Implemented OVOP (One Village One Product)

Result

Women gained work opportunities and their status improved

Today

The approach is now drawing attention in Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan too



► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

An example Reel introducing OVOP (One Village One Product). It tells the Why → What → Result → Today story above through a real interview.

③

Japanese Culture & Japan

Content about Japanese culture shouldn't turn into a plain "encyclopedia of Japanese culture" either.

✗ NG

✓ GOOD

"What is sushi?" → just explains the history and types of sushi

Why? This has a weak connection to JICA.

Combine Japanese culture × Kyrgyz people × JICA (e.g. Japanese culture as seen through Kyrgyz eyes, or a surprising thing Japan and Kyrgyzstan have in common)

Why? Combining these three elements keeps a clear connection to JICA while still featuring the culture.

Recommended approach

Japanese Culture × Kyrgyz People × JICA

In other words, combine Japanese culture, Kyrgyz people, and JICA. For example:

- Japanese culture as seen through Kyrgyz eyes
- Surprising things Japan and Kyrgyzstan have in common
- Cultural differences between Japan and Kyrgyzstan
- JICA staff introducing Japanese culture
- What Kyrgyz people felt about Japan

Post check quiz: which one misses the point?

► Show quiz answers (click to open)

► Show quiz answers (click to open)

Method

Learn how to plan, shoot, edit, and post an actual Instagram post.

What you'll learn in this section

- Decide whether a Reel or a Carousel is the right format
- Explain the production rules for Reels and Carousels
- Understand video structure (Hook–CTA), captions, hashtags, subtitles, thumbnails, and posting time rules

Reel or Carousel?

Check these two things.

- **Can you include audio information (narration/interview)?**
- **Can you shoot at least 5 visually different clips** (different colors, people, locations)?

If the answer to both is "no," go with a Carousel. The lower these two tendencies are, the less suited the content is to a Reel. Forcing it into a Reel anyway just loses the seriousness expected of a public institution. Reels reach well beyond your current followers but can actually reach existing followers less reliably. If your only goal is to reliably deliver information, an image carousel works better. It's more effective to publish one high-quality Reel a month than many low-quality ones. Don't force something into a Reel format when there's no real material for it.

Reel

Reel method

- Videos must always be **under 1 minute**. Documentaries can run longer out of necessity, but everything else should aim for 45 seconds or less.

- For slow speakers, speed the audio up to **1.3x** — enough to tighten the pace without sounding unnatural.
- **Subtitles and music are both required.** For subtitles: dictate the audio into ChatGPT, have it translated straight into Russian/Kyrgyz, then email it to your device and paste it in. (Trending templates are an exception, and music is optional — but subtitles are mandatory. Auto-generated subtitles make this easy, and subtitling doesn't take much time anyway.)
- Series content should share a consistent **opening**.
- Always include an **ending**.

9:16

Standard ratio for Reels



► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

An example ending: a simple, consistent close with the JICA Kyrgyz Republic Office logo and name.

 Before posting, make sure there is no CapCut watermark on the video.

11. Video structure

In general, use the following structure.

① Hook

Grab attention in the first 3 seconds.

"Why does ○○ happen?"

"○○ in Kyrgyzstan has changed."

"Actually, Japanese technology is used in this ○○."

"This place is connected to JICA."

"Japan and Kyrgyzstan have a surprising thing in common."

② Main Information

Deliver the most important information.

③ Story / Example

Show real people, places, numbers, or the actual site.

④ Result

Explain what changed as a result.

⑤ CTA

Prompt the viewer to take a next step.

Follow

Share

Comment

See more

See other posts

12. Reels operating rules

12-1. Video length

30–45 sec Target: length to aim for going forward (up to ~60 sec)

74.3 sec Reference: current average video length

Editing checkpoints

- Cut long greetings
- State the conclusion or the question up front
- Cut unnecessary movement/setup scenes

- Cut every "dead air" pause you can, even half a second — always look for unnecessary pauses to trim.

13. Video format (Reels)

9:16

Reels

Vertical video as the standard.

14. Subtitles

As a rule, every Reel should have subtitles. Currently only about a third of Reels are subtitled — going forward, every Reel should include them.

Subtitle rules

- Maximum 2 lines per screen
- Positioned so it doesn't overlap Instagram's UI
- Make sure the content can be understood with the sound off

15. Thumbnails

A thumbnail's job is to **communicate, in an instant, what the video is about.**

Project Update

→

Why does this road work in winter?

— use a title where the content or question is clear at a glance, like the example on the right.



A thumbnail example. Placing a question at the top, combined with subtitles, communicates "what is this video about" at a glance.

Also, don't change the design too much from Reel to Reel — keep a consistent layout.

16. CTA (Call to Action)

Include a CTA at the end of a post whenever possible. The goal isn't simply to ask for likes — it's to **prompt the viewer's next action**.

- Follow us for more JICA stories.
- What do you think?
- Have you ever experienced this?
- Share this with someone interested in Japan.

- Learn more about JDS.

- Check our Highlights for more information.

Choose the CTA to match the content of the post.

About Reel content

Entertainment

It must always tie back to introducing JICA's work. Don't film something purely because it looks fun or makes staff seem relatable!

The people who follow the account aren't following to watch entertaining moments or JICA staff dancing around. They follow because they want to know what JICA does and the information JICA provides — don't lose sight of that.

Example: Japanese-language intro × activity intro

This is recommended because it lets even a simple photo slideshow become highly entertaining while also introducing JICA's work. Since people interested in Japan tend to make up the follower base, introducing Japanese language content also makes sense.

It can be made just by swapping the video and caption on an existing CapCut project, so editing takes very little time. Once you've filmed the footage, it comes together quickly, can be shot by a single person, and doesn't require pulling other people in — making it an easy option.

How to make a documentary-style video



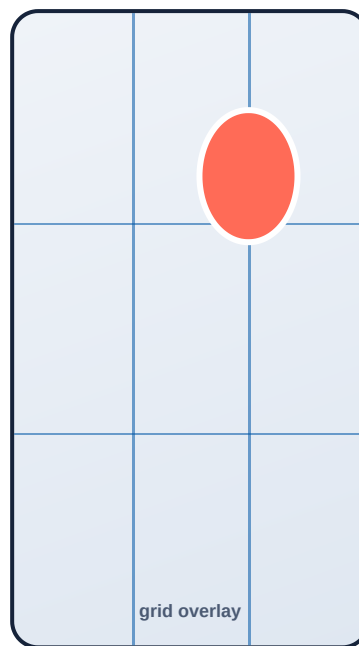
► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

An example of a documentary-style video: an interview shot from a 45-degree angle, combined with subtitles. Watch it alongside the "While filming," "Questions," and "While editing" points below.

While filming

- Film from a 45-degree angle, with someone other than the interviewer holding the camera. Keep the camera as still as possible — a fixed position if you can manage it.
- Always shoot using the grid. Line up the right-hand grid line with the subject's face, and leave about one grid square of space above their head.
- Separately, capture as much footage as possible of the person working or talking with someone — staged is fine if needed. If nothing else is available, film objects or scenery instead.
- If possible, ask the person in advance to send photos or video from that time via message.

- Expect to shoot around 30 minutes of footage to end up with 1 minute in the final cut.



Questions

- Prepare questions in advance.
- Ask questions that serve the goal of conveying what's great about JICA. Have a rough idea of the answer you expect, and ask in a way that draws out that content.
- When interviewing Kyrgyz speakers, either use an interpreter or ask the question in English and let them answer in Russian or Kyrgyz. Since it will be translated into Kyrgyz anyway, don't force them to answer in English.

While editing

- Start with the interview subject speaking on camera. At a natural break, around 2–5 seconds in, switch to audio-only from the interview while showing different footage, then cut back to the subject at the end of their answer.
- Don't include the audio of the question itself — show it as on-screen text near the top of the frame instead.
- Subtitles and music are required.

- Narrow it down to around 3 strong questions/answers that really convey what's great about JICA, and keep it within 60 seconds. If it genuinely won't fit, split it into Part 1 and Part 2.

Column: a request about appearing on camera, and how to shoot it

The single most important thing in content creation is personalization. Having a real person appear and speak gets far higher engagement. Even a one-line appearance is a big help, so please cooperate wherever you can.

Content needs to keep being made, so having appeared before doesn't mean you're exempt every time. That said, be careful not to let the burden fall too heavily on any one person.

Recommended content

At JICA Kyrgyzstan, personalized video is hard to produce. As a workaround, when visiting a project, interview an external person involved in it with 2–3 questions, or film them giving a short speech.

-  If it's an external interview, **faces don't need to be shown**. Filming just their feet with voice-only audio is fine too. Audio is critical for Reels either way.

Reel quiz

- ▶ Show quiz answers (click to open)

Carousel

Carousel method

- Always use this outer frame, at minimum for the **thumbnail**.
- Always post at a **4:5 (width:height)** ratio. Posting at any other ratio makes each post look inconsistent, creates awkward blank space, and undermines the solidity and professionalism expected of a public institution.

- For this reason, shoot photos **vertically** whenever possible!
- If a photo ends up horizontal, use the thumbnail to fill the blank space and post it at this ratio.



An example of the outer-frame template actually in use (a post introducing a dairy-sector project). The JICA logo sits in a band at the top and the title in a band at the bottom — this layout is kept consistent across every carousel post.

<https://canva.link/hmbmtl3komvntci>

Open the outer-frame template (Canva) →

4:5

Standard ratio for carousel / photo posts

13. Photo/carousel format

4:5

Photos / Carousel
as the standard.

Use JICA Blue as the main color, and keep the logo position, logo size, font, design template, and title position consistent wherever possible. The goal is for **a post to be instantly recognizable as JICA content**.

Carousel quiz

► Show quiz answers (click to open)

Caption & Posting Time

17. Captions

📘 Summarize the video's content and feed it into an AI tool — it can draft a caption for you directly. Copy the prompt below to use it.

✳ Copy-paste prompt (AI caption generator)

```
Create an Instagram caption based on the video/image content below.
Write in : Russian and Kyrgyz.
Requirements:
* 70–80 words max per language
* Add information/context that is not obvious from the video/image; do not
  simply repeat it.
* Structure: Hook → brief context/details → CTA
* Natural, friendly, professional tone for JICA Kyrgyzstan's official
  Instagram
* Do not invent information.
* Use 0–3 emojis if appropriate.
* Hashtags: #JICA #JICAKyrgyzstan #JapanKyrgyzstan + up to 2 relevant
  hashtags

After the two captions, add a short Japanese explanation of the caption's
meaning
Video/image content:
[PASTE CONTENT HERE]
```

Paste a description of the video/image content (what's shown, what's said, etc.) in place of "[PASTE CONTENT HERE]" before using it.

17-1. Basic policy

A caption's role is to add information that can't be understood from the video or image alone. As a guideline, aim for **roughly 70–80 words per language**, using Kyrgyz, Russian, and English as needed.

17-2. Caption structure

① Hook

Grab attention in the first line.

② Body

Explain what didn't fit into the first line.

③ Details

Project name, people involved, titles, etc.

④ CTA

A question, a follow prompt, a share prompt, a link, etc.

⑤ Hashtags

Relevant hashtags.

18. Caption hooks

The very first sentence matters most. Patterns you can use:

QUESTION

"Why does this road remain usable even in winter?"

NUMBER

"3 things you didn't know about ○○"

CONCLUSION

"This project changed ○○."

PERSON

"Meet the Kyrgyz engineer working with JICA."

UNEXPECTED FACT

"Did you know that ○○ was introduced to Kyrgyzstan through...?"

19. Hashtags

Don't pile on large numbers of hashtags — use **a fixed set plus tags specific to the post**.

Fixed hashtags: up to 3

#JICA

#JICAKyrgyzstan

#JapanKyrgyzstan

Content-specific tags: up to 2

#OVOP

#JOCV

#IssykKul

#Osh

 The source material also proposes roughly 3 fixed hashtags plus around 2 content-specific tags.

20. Emoji

Use emoji in captions where appropriate. The goal is to make the text feel friendly and easy to read. Avoid overusing them, though — aim for **around 0–3 per post**.

21. Posting time



17:00–18:00

Weekdays, around when school/work ends

Also, use Instagram's scheduled-posting feature so the team doesn't need to manually post every single time.

Caption & posting time quiz

► Show quiz answers (click to open)

How to Use CapCut

A hands-on section where you bring CapCut and learn by using it together.

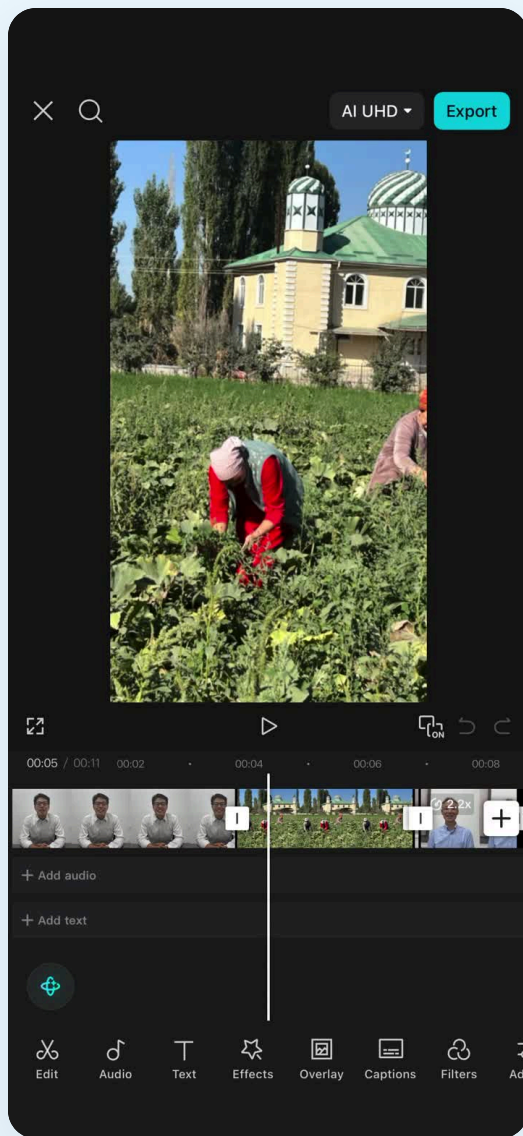
What you'll learn in this section

Be able to carry out all 12 basic operations needed for Reel editing in CapCut

Work through each operation confidently while following its screen recording

How to Use CapCut

Learn these 12 operations and you'll be able to handle the full Reel-editing workflow in CapCut. Each item includes a screen recording, plus an explanation in words of which button does what.



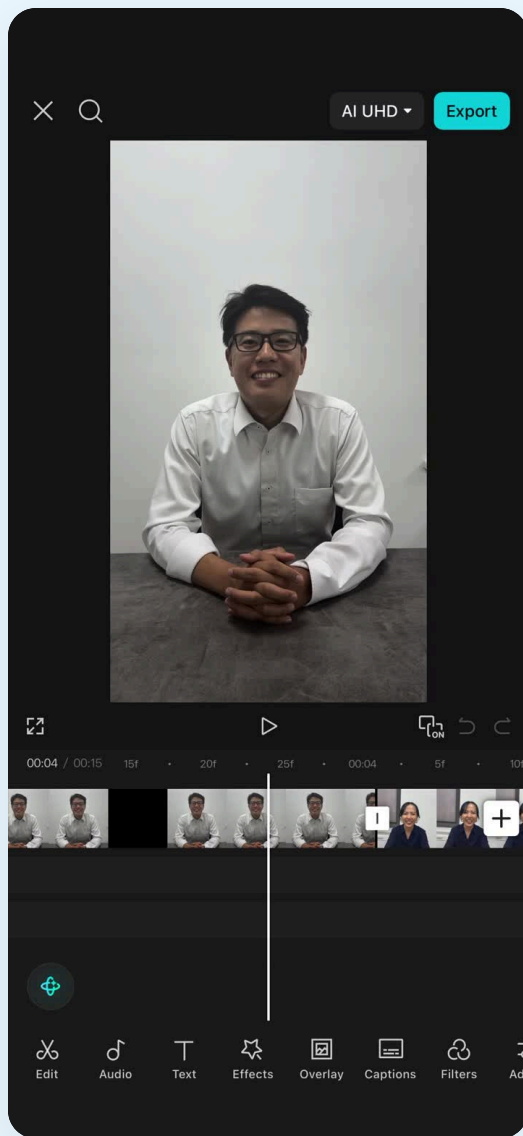
► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

1

Fit the photo to the screen

After adding a photo or video to the timeline, resize it so it fills the screen, with no empty margins.

1. Tap the photo (or video) clip on the timeline to select it.
2. Scroll the toolbar at the bottom to the right and tap "Crop."
3. Drag the corners of the cyan frame so the photo fills the whole screen (make sure no black bars remain at the top or bottom).
4. Tap the checkmark (✓) in the top right to confirm.



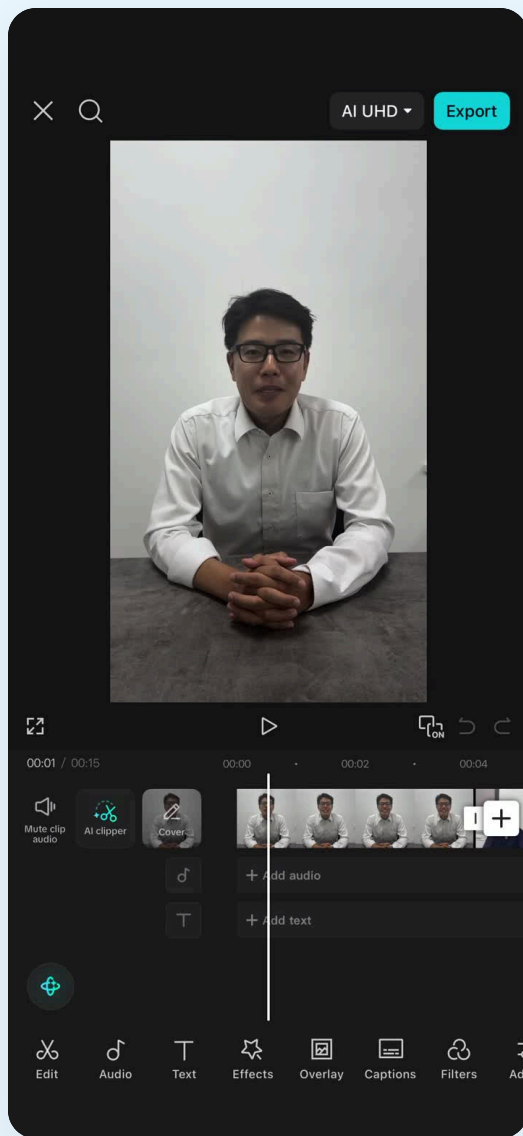
► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

2

How to cut

The basic operation: split the timeline where you don't need footage, then delete it.

1. Move the playhead to the point where you want to cut.
2. Tap the clip to select it.
3. Tap "Split" in the bottom toolbar — this divides the clip in two at that point.
4. Tap the piece you don't need, then tap the trash icon (Delete) to remove it.



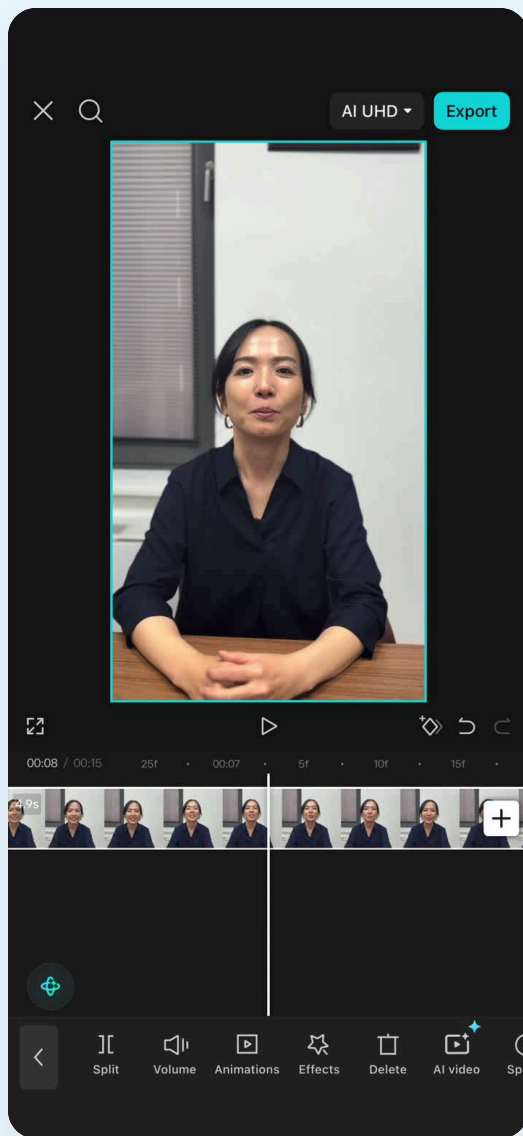
► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

3

Cut zoom / frame enlargement

Add a zoom (frame enlargement) at a cut point so the footage doesn't feel monotonous.

1. Tap the clip you want to zoom in on.
2. Tap "Crop" in the bottom toolbar (the same tool used in step 1, "Fit the photo to the screen").
3. Drag the corners of the cyan frame slightly inward so the framing is a little tighter than the previous clip.
4. Confirm with the checkmark. Changing the zoom level a little with each cut keeps the pacing feeling natural instead of repetitive.



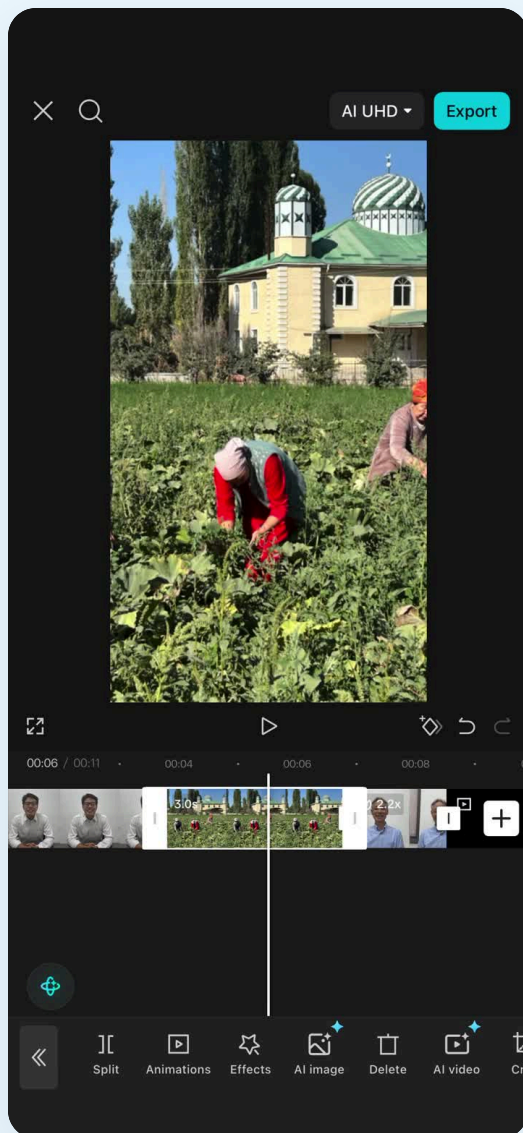
► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

4

Speed up slow speech

For someone who speaks slowly on camera, set that footage to **1.3x speed** to keep the pace up — just enough that it doesn't feel unnatural.

1. Tap the clip you want to speed up.
2. Tap "Speed" in the bottom toolbar.
3. Staying on the "Normal" tab, drag the slider from 1.0x to around 1.3x (the new duration is shown at the top).
4. If the voice pitch sounds unnatural, turn on "Change audio pitch."
5. Confirm with the checkmark.



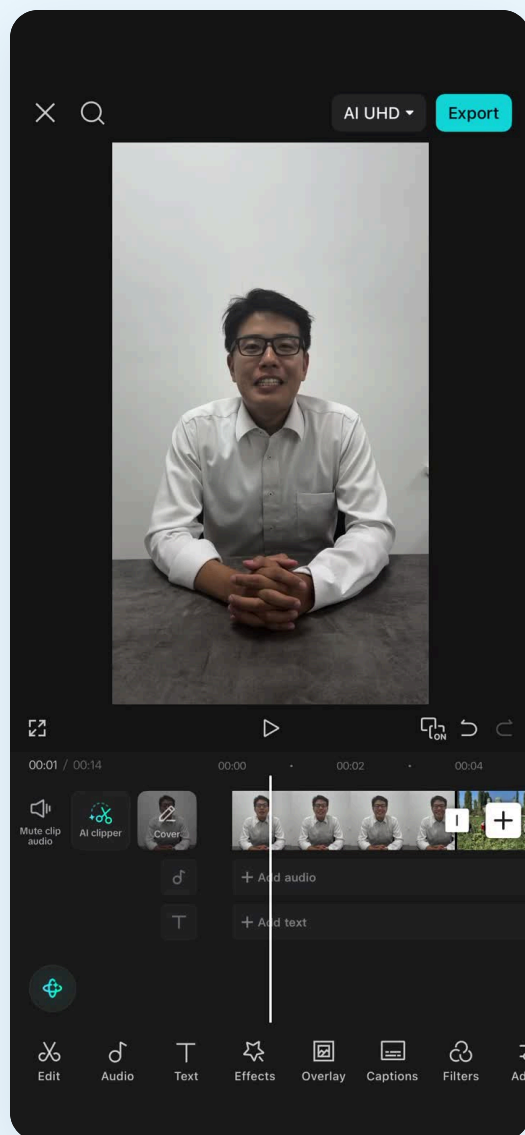
► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

5

Photo fade-in

How to set a soft fade-in for a photo as it appears.

1. Tap the clip you want to fade in.
2. Scroll the bottom toolbar to the left and tap "Video effects."
3. Find "Fade In" in the effects list and tap it.
4. Once applied, a highlighted band appears at the start of the clip. Confirm with the checkmark.



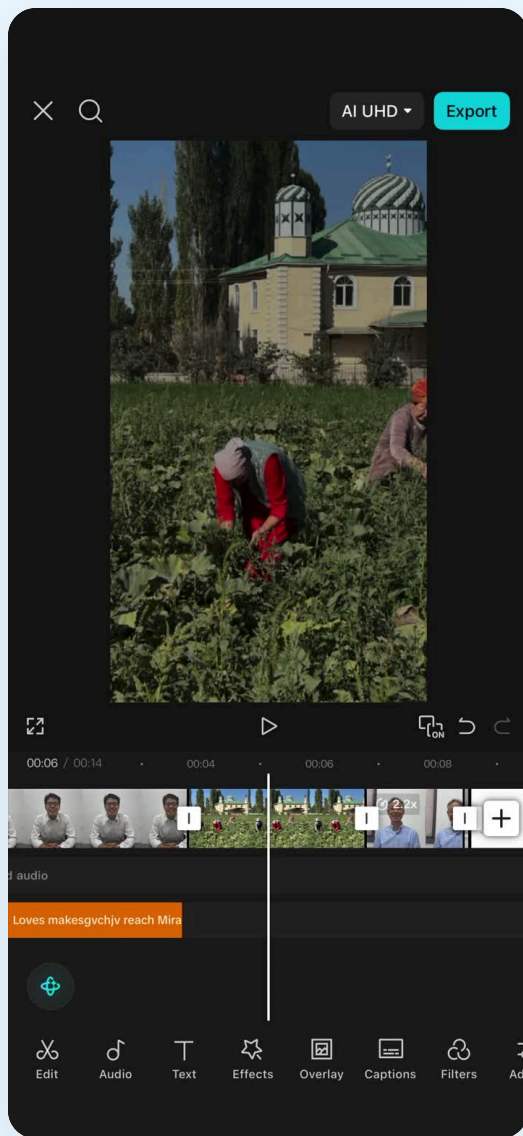
► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

6

Subtitles

Show what's being said as on-screen text, so the content comes across even without sound. Always check for mistakes afterward.

1. Move the playhead to where each line of speech happens.
2. Tap "Text" → "Add text" in the bottom toolbar.
3. Pick a consistent style from "Templates" (for example, a simple outlined-text template) and type in the line being spoken.
4. Drag the edges of the text box to adjust its size and position (somewhere that doesn't overlap Instagram's own UI).
5. Confirm with the checkmark, and repeat for each line.
6. Depending on the spoken language, you can also generate captions automatically from the same menu's "Auto captions."



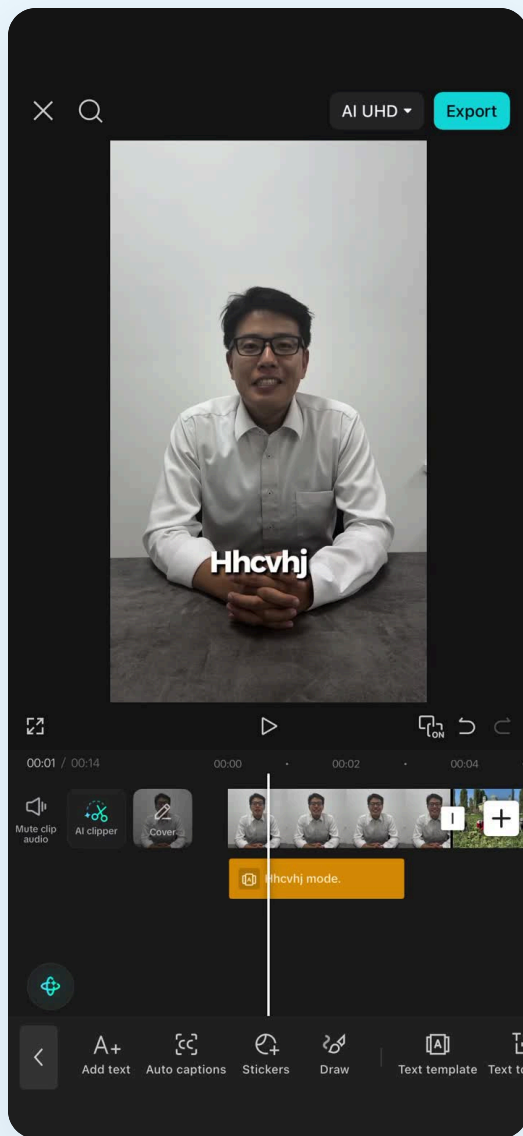
► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

7

Add music

How to add background music.

1. Tap "Audio" → "Sounds" in the bottom toolbar.
2. Search by keyword, or browse Recommended tracks or categories like Vlog or Tense.
3. Preview a track with its play button, then tap "+" to add it to the timeline.
4. Trim the music clip on the timeline to match the video's length.



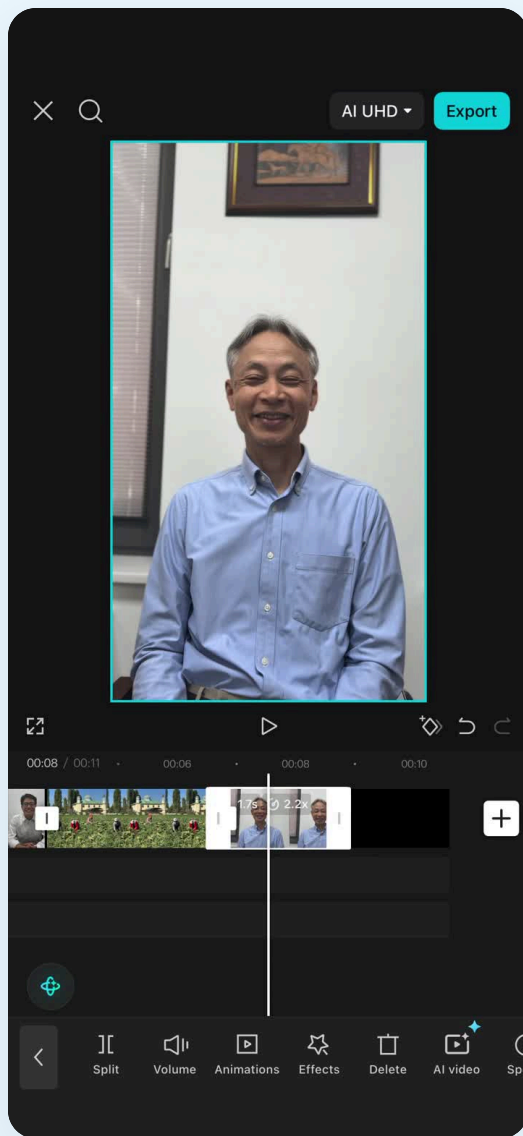
► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

8

Add a title

How to add an opening title/text at the start of the video.

1. Move the playhead to the very start of the video.
2. Tap "Text" → "Add text," then pick a title-style template from "Templates" (e.g. bold text with an accent color).
3. Type in the title text.
4. Drag it to a position that doesn't overlap the captions (e.g. near the top of the screen).
5. Confirm with the checkmark.



► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

9

Add an ending

How to add an ending at the end of the video.

1. Tap the "+" at the very end of the timeline.
2. Choose the shared ending video (the JICA logo card) from "Recents" or wherever it's saved.
3. Trim the length if needed, then tap "Add" to append it right after the main footage.



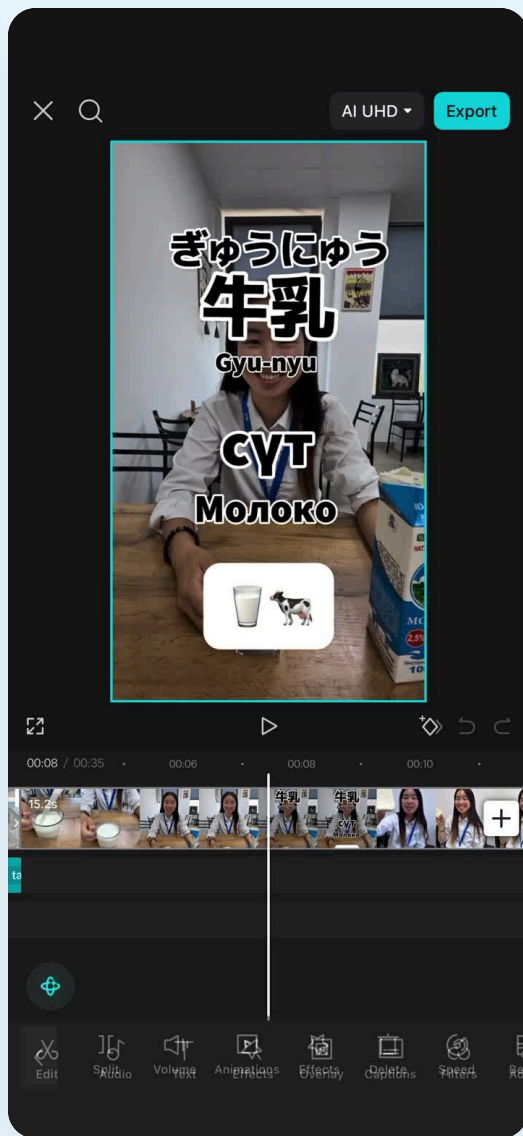
► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

10

Save in high quality

How to set resolution, frame rate, and bitrate to their high-quality settings when exporting.

1. Tap "AI UHD" next to the "Export" button in the top right to open the export settings.
2. Set "Resolution" to 1080P or 4K.
3. Set "Frame rate" to 30 (or 60 for smoother motion).
4. Set "Bitrate" as high as practical (use the Recommended value as a guide, or the maximum).
5. Once everything's set, tap "Export" to render and save the video.



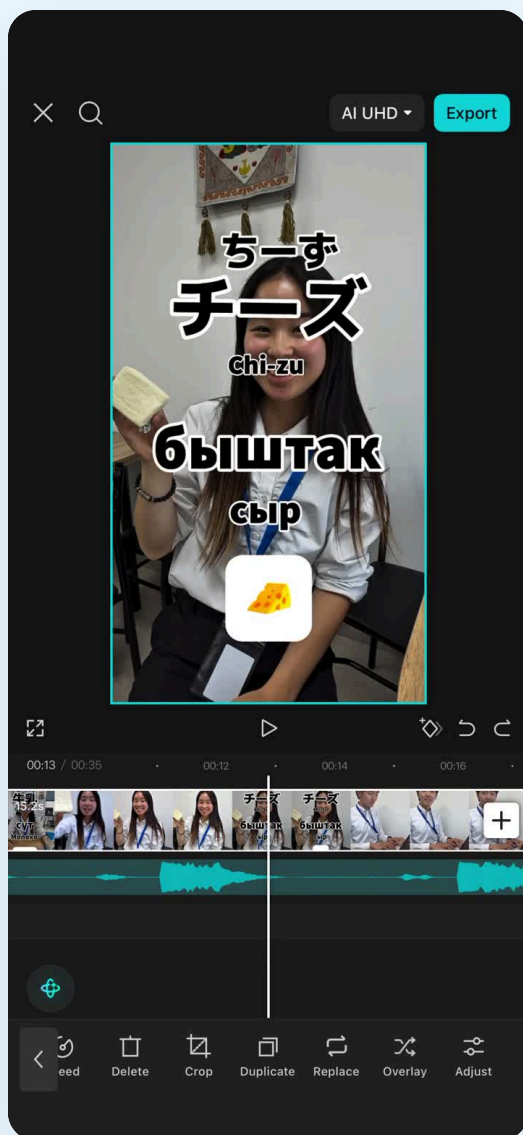
► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

11

Extracting audio from a video

How to pull just the audio out of a clip so you can edit it as its own, separate track.

1. Tap the clip you want to extract audio from to select it.
2. Tap "AudioExtract" in the bottom toolbar.
3. The extracted audio clip can be tapped and edited on its own, just like any other clip — volume, trimming, fades, and audio effects all apply to it independently.



► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

12

Replacing a video or photo

How to swap out just the footage in a clip while keeping its subtitles, text, and effects exactly as they are. **Handy for series content that reuses a past video's template.**

1. Tap the clip you want to replace to select it.
2. Tap "Replace" in the bottom toolbar.
3. Choose the new video or photo from "Recents" (or another source).
4. A trim screen appears so the new footage matches the length of the original clip — adjust the position, then tap "Confirm."
5. Only the footage changes; the clip's subtitles, text, and effects stay exactly as they were.

Almost every video-editing feature you could need is available in CapCut — you can recreate edits you've seen on YouTube or TV! For now, we recommend exploring the app's features yourself and trying things out, and looking things up if something doesn't work. Never compromise on quality.

How to Use Canva

Learn how to use Canva to create Instagram images and carousels.

What you'll learn in this section

Open the shared Canva project and swap in a new thumbnail image

Understand that you can work from either a PC or the PR phone using the same steps

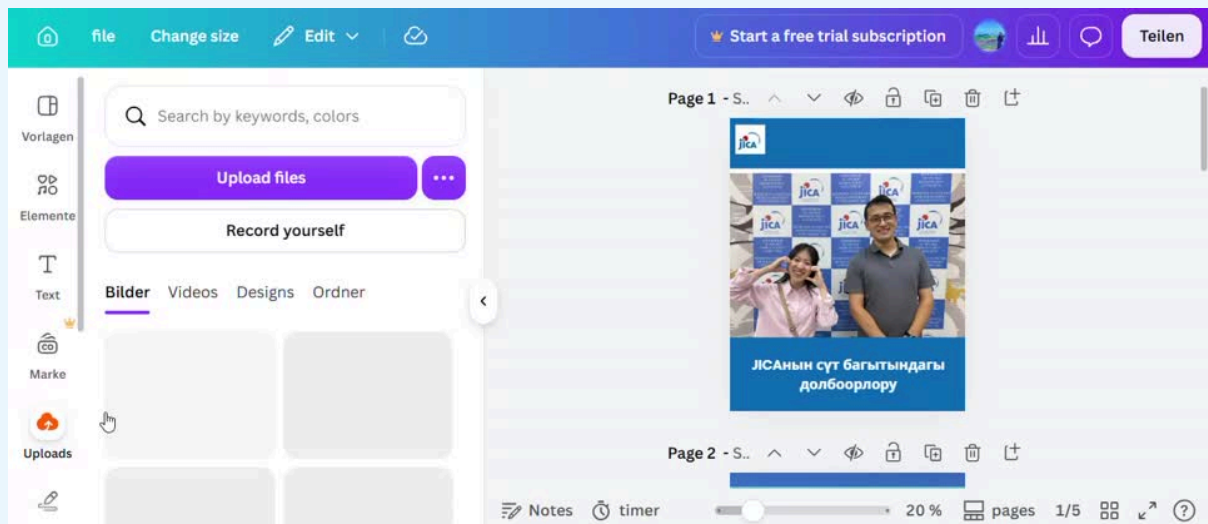
Confidently upload photos and download a finished design while following the screen recordings

How to use Canva

<https://canva.link/hmbmtl3komvntci>

Open the shared Canva project →

Access the link above to create a thumbnail. You can work from either a PC or the PR phone.



► Watch this video in the web version of the manual.

1 Uploading and swapping in a photo

How to upload a photo from your computer or phone into Canva, and swap it into a template.

1. Tap "Uploads" in the left-hand toolbar.
2. Tap "Upload files" and choose the photo you want to use.
3. Once it's uploaded, the thumbnail appears in the Uploads panel.
4. Drag that thumbnail onto the photo you want to replace (it swaps in automatically).
5. If needed, drag the corner handles to adjust the photo's size and position.

Pre-Post Checklist

The items you must check every single time, before posting to Instagram.

Before you hit "post," go through this page from top to bottom. Once everything is checked, you're good to go.

Are you choosing between Reel and Carousel correctly?

- ☐ Can you include audio information (narration/interview)?
- ☐ Can you shoot at least 5 visually different clips (different colors, people, locations)?

Content

- ☐ Is the message of this post narrowed down to just one thing?
- ☐ Can someone who doesn't know JICA's work understand it?
- ☐ Is it more than just a plain activity report?
- ☐ Does it show something only JICA can show?

Reel

- ☐ Does it include audio information (narration/interview)?
- ☐ Does it grab attention in the first 3 seconds?
- ☐ Is there suitable music?
- ☐ Does it fit within roughly 30–45 seconds?
- ☐ Are there no long greetings or introductions?
- ☐ Is there no moment you could trim, even by 0.5 seconds?
- ☐ Are there subtitles?
- ☐ Are the subtitles within 2 lines?
- ☐ Do the subtitles avoid overlapping Instagram's on-screen buttons and icons (the UI)?
- ☐ Can the thumbnail alone communicate what it's about?
- ☐ Does the visual change every couple of seconds?
- ☐ **Make sure there is no CapCut watermark on the video**

Caption

- ☐ Is there an opening line that grabs the reader's interest (a Hook)?
- ☐ Is it not too long?
- ☐ Does it add the necessary supporting information?
- ☐ Is there a line prompting the viewer to take an action (a CTA), such as follow, save, or learn more?
- ☐ Are the hashtags appropriate?
- ☐ Are the Kyrgyz/Russian, etc. language settings correct?

Design

- ☐ Is a thumbnail being used? If not, go to Canva (<https://canva.link/hmbmtl3komvntci>) and make one
- ☐ Is the logo position and size consistent?
- ☐ Is the text easy to read?
- ☐ Is it 4:5 or 9:16?

How to Write Website Articles

Learn how to write articles for the JICA Kyrgyz Republic Office's official website, and how to take photos for them.

What you'll learn in this section

- Explain how an official website article differs from an Instagram post in purpose and audience
- Apply the basic rules for titles, lead paragraphs, and paragraph breaks, using concrete examples
- Understand how to photograph an article — orientation, framing, number of shots, and how to reduce camera shake

1. How website articles differ from Instagram

1-1. Different purpose, different audience

Instagram is a medium where someone scrolling casually happens to come across a post. The official website, by contrast, is a medium **people actively visit because they already want to find out something about the JICA Kyrgyz Republic Office.**



Who reads it

Government ministries,
press, researchers,
prospective applicants,
and more



Why they read it

To find accurate
information they can
treat as a factual record



What to write

What happened, when,
and how — accurately
and concisely

Instagram's goal is to "catch the attention of someone who happens to see it." A website article's goal is **"to deliver accurate, easy-to-understand information to someone who is already looking for it."** So there's no need for a hook question or attention-grabbing language — instead, prioritize stating the facts concisely and accurately.

2. Before you start writing

- **Keep sentences short and concise.** Don't cram too much information into one sentence.
- Before you start writing, sketch out the overall structure (intro → body → conclusion).
- Before you go out to interview or cover the story, prepare a planned draft (an outline) based on what you already know, and make clear what still needs to be confirmed on the day — it makes the actual interviewing and writing much smoother.
- It's fine to reference past articles, but **never copy their wording or figures as-is.** Always update dates, titles, and numbers to the current, correct information.



The JICA Kyrgyz Republic Office has, in cooperation with the Government of the Kyrgyz Republic and relevant ministries, continuously implemented multiple projects related to human resource development and technical cooperation in the agricultural sector, thereby making a significant contribution to improving local productivity.

Why? Too much information is packed into one sentence, making it hard to tell which point matters most.



The JICA Kyrgyz Republic Office has worked with the Kyrgyz government to develop human resources in the agricultural sector. As a result, local productivity has improved.

Why? Breaking it into short sentences organizes the information and makes it easier to read.

3. Going out to interview or cover a story

- Arrange the schedule as early as possible, and put the other person's availability first.
- Confirm whether you may record the conversation before the interview begins.
- Stick to the agreed time.

- Prepare your questions ahead of time — think through what you want to ask and how it will be used in the article before you go.

4. Titles and headlines

A title doesn't need to be a "you'll want to keep reading" hook question the way an Instagram post does. **Prioritize making it clear who did what, just from reading the title.**



Training held in Kyrgyzstan

Why? It's unclear who held the training or what it was for — the reader can't picture the article's content.



JICA and Kyrgyz Ministry of Agriculture hold joint dairy technology training

Why? The parties involved (JICA, the ministry) and the content (dairy technology training) are clear at a glance.



A new project has begun

Why? "New" and "project" alone give no sense of where or what specifically has started.



New irrigation project launches in five villages of Issyk-Kul region

Why? The location (Issyk-Kul region), scale (five villages), and content (irrigation) are all concrete.



The JICA Kyrgyz Republic Office held an exchange of views last week in Bishkek together with relevant ministries on human resource development in the education sector, and discussed the future direction of cooperation

Why? Too much information is crammed into one long sentence, making it hard to read as a title (aim for roughly 30–40 characters in Japanese, or a similarly tight length in English).



JICA and Kyrgyz Ministry of Education and Science discuss strengthening human resource cooperation

Why? Narrowing it down to the key point makes for a short title that's clear at a glance.



**You won't believe how much
Kyrgyzstan's education is changing!?**

Why? Exclamation points and attention-grabbing phrasing belong on Instagram, not in an official article's title.



**Kyrgyz Ministry of Education and
Science and JICA launch teacher
training program**

Why? State the facts plainly, but clearly.

5. Lead paragraphs

In the lead (the article's opening one or two sentences), **state concisely, up front, who did what, when, and where**. Save the detailed background for the body of the article.



**The other day, something rather
memorable happened. It may turn out to
be a turning point for Kyrgyzstan's
agricultural sector.**

Why? It takes too long to get to the main point (who, when, what), so the reader can't quickly find the information they came for.



**The JICA Kyrgyz Republic Office held a
meeting with the Kyrgyz Ministry of
Water Resources, Agriculture and
Processing Industry in Bishkek on
August 20 to discuss agricultural
technical cooperation.**

Why? "Who (JICA), when (August 20), where (Bishkek), what (held a meeting)" is all clear from the very first sentence.



**Ahead of Kyrgyzstan's Independence
Day, the JICA Kyrgyz Republic Office, as
part of agricultural cooperation that has
continued since 2015, held a meeting in
Bishkek on August 20 with officials from
the Kyrgyz Ministry of Water Resources,
Agriculture and Processing Industry —
also attended by local media — to
discuss a five-year technical
cooperation plan.**



**The JICA Kyrgyz Republic Office held a
meeting with the Kyrgyz Ministry of
Water Resources, Agriculture and
Processing Industry in Bishkek on
August 20, and discussed five years of
future agricultural technical cooperation.**

Why? The lead sticks to the key point; background details (Independence Day, the history since 2015) move to the body.

Why? Cramming everything into one sentence actually makes the key point harder to find.

6. Line breaks and paragraphing

- **Start a new paragraph whenever the topic changes.** Don't pack more than one topic into a single paragraph.
- For a Japanese-language article, aim for **roughly 3–5 sentences per paragraph** (adjust proportionally for English). Split it up if it runs longer.
- From the **second paragraph onward**, include a quote from the person you interviewed — it makes the article far more convincing.

Example paragraph structure

Paragraph 1: Lead

Concisely summarize who, when, where, and what.

Paragraph 2 onward: A voice from the field, and background

Quote something the interviewee said, and explain the background and specifics of the work.

Final paragraph: Looking ahead

Convey future plans and what this work means going forward.

"Thanks to this training, I gained new knowledge about dairy quality control," said an official from the Ministry of Agriculture.

"Learning Japanese techniques will be a huge help in my future work," said one of the Kyrgyz participants.

7. Once you've finished writing

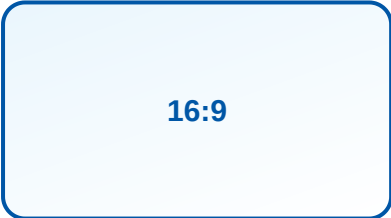
- **Read it out loud** and check for typos, missing words, or awkward phrasing.
- Avoid technical jargon and abbreviations wherever possible. If you must use one, always add a brief explanation.
- **If you're not sure who the audience is, write so that a middle- or high-school student could understand it.**

【Photography】

Photos for articles are shot differently than an Instagram Reel (vertical video). Keep the following points in mind.

① Shoot horizontally (landscape)

An Instagram Reel is vertical (9:16) by default, but **photos for a website article should be landscape (e.g. 16:9) by default**. A vertical shot won't fit the article layout and leaves awkward blank space above, below, or to the sides. Shooting landscape also **makes the footage easier to hand off to other media outlets, such as TV (it's more compatible with their formats)**.



16:9

Basic aspect ratio for article photos (landscape)

② Don't zoom — physically move closer

Using a phone's zoom degrades image quality. **To preserve quality, don't use zoom — physically move closer to the subject instead.**

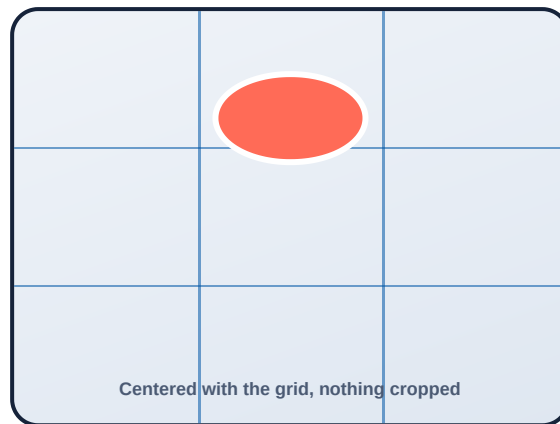
Zooming in from a distance with the phone →

Skip zoom — physically move closer to the subject

Zoom degrades image quality, so close the physical distance whenever you can.

③ Use the grid lines to keep the subject centered

Turn on your phone's grid lines, and make sure **the subject stays centered in frame and that no part of anyone's body gets cut off** at the edge.



④ Take extra shots of group photos (burst mode)

For group photos, **always take several shots — burst mode if possible**. A single shot often turns out unusable because someone blinked.

⑤ Also take some photos with movement

A stiff, standing-in-a-row commemorative shot with everyone looking at the camera is perfectly fine for that purpose. On top of that, **also take some separate photos that capture a moment of movement — someone working, pointing, talking, or laughing** — they make it much easier to convey the actual scene when they run in the article.

- Commemorative photo: a stiff, standing-in-a-row shot looking at the camera works fine.
- One more for the article: also capture a moment of activity, gesture, or expression.

⑥ Tuck in your elbows to reduce shake

Tuck both elbows firmly in against your body while shooting — it significantly reduces camera shake.

⑦ Tips for shooting a panorama

When shooting in panorama mode, how you move your body can minimize blur in your torso.

① Fix your lower body

Point your hips and legs toward the middle of the whole panning range, and keep them still throughout the shot.

② **Twist your upper body**

Twist only your upper body around to your starting position before you begin.

③ **Shoot as you untwist**

Once you start the shutter, keep your lower body fixed and slowly untwist your upper body as you shoot.

 Keeping your lower body fixed and moving only your upper body keeps your center of gravity steady, which makes the seams in a panorama photo blend much more smoothly.

► **Show quiz answers (click to open)**

One more look before you post.

Go through the Pre-Post Checklist from top to bottom, then confirm with Aisuluu and Svetlana once everything is checked.